

CASE FILE 01

Republic of Veritas

Ministry of Information Integrity

Public Safety Directorate

Case ID: RV-MI-2023-014

Classification: Public Record

Subject: Arvind Rao

Status: Closed

Threat Level: None Identified

1. Personal Profile

Full Name: Arvind Rao

Age: 42

Occupation: Senior Investigative Correspondent

Media Affiliation: The Civic Ledger

Years of Service: 18

Areas of Coverage: Infrastructure, Resource Allocation, Policy Transparency

Mr. Rao was widely recognized for his analytical reporting style and document-heavy investigative features. His prior publications focused on regulatory inefficiencies and budget utilization inconsistencies. No prior criminal record. No known political affiliations officially declared.

2. Investigation Published

Title of Article:

“Subterranean Allocations: A Review of Mining Contract Transparency”

Publication Date: 04 March 2023

Summary of Findings

The article examined the allocation of mineral extraction contracts across three northern provinces. Key areas of concern raised:

- Rapid reassignment of long-standing contracts.
- Bidding process timelines shortened significantly.
- Regulatory approvals processed within 48 hours.
- Environmental clearance documents signed retroactively.

Mr. Rao cited internal audit documents and procurement records that indicated potential procedural bypassing.

The article concluded with the following line:

“citizens still retain their Voluntary Opportunity In observing Civic Evidence...”

3. Timeline of Events

04 March 2023 — Article published.

07 March 2023 — Public debate begins across digital platforms.

09 March 2023 — Ministry issues clarification notes stating “all procedures complied with regulatory standards.”

12 March 2023 — Mr. Rao reports receiving “persistent anonymous calls,” as per colleague statements.

16 March 2023 — CCTV near residence reportedly malfunctioned due to maintenance error.

17 March 2023 — Fatal Road accident recorded at 23:14 hours.

Time between publication and death: **13 days**

4. Incident Report

Location: Outer Ring Highway, Sector 11

Weather Conditions: Clear

Vehicle Condition: Moderate frontal damage

Skid Marks: Minimal

Airbag Deployment: Confirmed

Brake System: Under investigation at time of report

Initial police assessment categorized the event as a high-speed vehicular collision. No second vehicle identified at the scene.

Witness accounts inconsistent.

One bystander reported:

“It did not look like loss of control.”

Statement later revised to:

“I may have misjudged from distance.”

5. Forensic Observations

- Mobile phone missing from crash site.
- Laptop recovered but hard drive corrupted.
- Call log retrieval unsuccessful.
- Dashcam storage formatted.

No external tampering officially identified.

6. Official Statement

The Ministry of Information Integrity issued the following release:

“The Republic of Veritas reiterates that press freedom remains uncompromised. The unfortunate accident bears no connection to Mr. Rao’s recent reporting. Authorities have found no evidence suggesting targeted action.”

Case formally closed on 28 March 2023.

7. Media Impact

Following Mr. Rao’s death:

- Mining contract discussions significantly reduced in national media.
- Online debates moderated under “misinformation policy.”
- Editorial team of The Civic Ledger restructured.

Internal memo (leaked anonymously):

“All future investigative submissions require pre-clearance from legal compliance.”

8. Closing Remark (Internal)

“The stability of democratic institutions depends on responsible communication.”

End of Record.